Particle Physics Note

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Contents

1 Decay Rate & Cross Sections **1**

1.1 Fermi Golden Rule 1

1.2 Decay Rate 2

1.3 Cross Sections 2

2 Klein-Gordon Equation **3**

Chapter 1

Decay Rate & Cross Sections

§ 1.1 Fermi Golden Rule

Consider time-dependent Schrödinger equation,

$$i\frac{d\psi}{dt} = \hat{H}(t)\psi. \tag{1.1}$$

We can separate Hamiltonian operator into two parts, one is time-independent, and else is time-dependent,

$$\hat{H}(t) = \hat{H}_0 + \hat{H}'(\mathrm{x}, t) \tag{1.2}$$

For time-independent part we can use common method to solve it,

$$\hat{H}_0\psi_k = E_k\psi_k, \quad \text{and} \quad \langle\psi_j|\psi_k\rangle = \delta_{jk} \tag{1.3}$$

Then the wavefunction can be expressed in terms of complete set of states of the unperturbed Hamiltonian as

$$\psi(\mathrm{x}, t) = \sum_k c_k(t)\psi(\mathrm{x})e^{-iE_k t}. \tag{1.4}$$

Then we can substitute Eq. 1.4 into Eq. 1.1, we can get

$$\begin{aligned} i\sum_k \left[\frac{\mathrm{d}c_k}{\mathrm{d}t}\psi_k e^{-iE_k t} - iE_k c_k \psi_k e^{-iE_k t}\right] &= \sum_k c_k \hat{H}_0 \psi_k e^{-iE_k t} + \sum_k \hat{H}' c_k \psi_k e^{-iE_k t} \\ \Rightarrow \quad i\sum_k \frac{\mathrm{d}c_k}{\mathrm{d}t}\psi_k e^{-iE_k t} &= \sum_k \hat{H}' c_k(t)\psi_k e^{-iE_k t} \end{aligned} \tag{1.5}$$

Suppose the initial state is i for $\psi_i \equiv |i\rangle$, that is

$$\psi(\mathrm{x}, 0) = \sum_k c_k(0)\psi_k = c_i(0)\psi_i. \tag{1.6}$$

We can easily imply that $c_k = \delta_{ik}$. Assume that time-dependent Hamiltonian is perturbed, which implies $c_{i\neq k} \ll 1, c_i \sim 1$. And Eq. 1.5 can reduce to

$$i\sum_k \frac{\mathrm{d}c_k}{\mathrm{d}t} |k\rangle e^{-iE_k t} \approx \hat{H}' |i\rangle e^{-iE_i t} \tag{1.7}$$

Then we need to get to final state, so we can use relation of inner product, let $\langle f|$ act on Eq. 1.7, we can get the coefficient c_f

$$\frac{dc_f}{dt} = -i \langle f|\hat{H}'|i\rangle e^{-i(E_i-E_f)t}, \tag{1.8}$$

where $\langle f|\hat{H}'|i\rangle \equiv T_{fi}$ is **transition matrix element**, can be calculated by

$$\langle f|\hat{H}'|i\rangle = \int_V \psi_f^\dagger(\mathrm{x})\hat{H}'\psi_i(\mathrm{x})\,\mathrm{d}^3\mathrm{x}\,. \tag{1.9}$$

Then we can calculate the coefficient c_f, at time $t = T$

$$c_f(T) = -i\int_0^T T_{fi}e^{-i(E_i-E_f)t}\,\mathrm{d}t \tag{1.10}$$

The probability for a transition to the state $|f\rangle$ is given by

$$P_{if} = c_f^\dagger(t)c_f(t) = |T_{fi}|^2 \int_0^T\int_0^T e^{-i(E_i-E_f)t}e^{-i(E_i-E_f)t'}\,\mathrm{d}t\,\mathrm{d}t' \tag{1.11}$$

And we have **transition rate** $\mathrm{d}\Gamma_{fi}$ from the initial state $|i\rangle$ to the single final state $|f\rangle$

$$\mathrm{d}\Gamma_{fi} = \frac{P_{fi}}{T} = \frac{1}{T}|T_{fi}|^2 \int_{-T/2}^{T/2}\int_{-T/2}^{T/2} e^{-i(E_i-E_f)t}e^{-i(E_i-E_f)t'}\,\mathrm{d}t\,\mathrm{d}t' \tag{1.12}$$

If we consider the time is long enough comparing to transition progress, we can take a limit

$$\mathrm{d}\Gamma_{fi} = |T_{fi}|^2 \lim_{T\to\infty}\left\{\frac{1}{T}\int_{-\frac{T}{2}}^{+\frac{T}{2}}\int_{-\frac{T}{2}}^{+\frac{T}{2}} e^{i\left(E_f-E_i\right)t}e^{-i\left(E_f-E_i\right)t'}\mathrm{d}t\,\mathrm{d}t'\right\} \tag{1.13}$$

Associated with the definition of Dirac delta-function, the integral over $\mathrm{d}t'$ can be replaced by $2\pi\delta(E_f - E_i)$ and thus

$$\mathrm{d}\Gamma_{fi} = 2\pi\,|T_{fi}|^2 \lim_{T\to\infty}\left\{\frac{1}{T}\int_{-\frac{T}{2}}^{+\frac{T}{2}} e^{i\left(E_f-E_i\right)t}\delta\left(E_f - E_i\right)\mathrm{d}t\right\} \tag{1.14}$$

§1.2 Decay Rate

§1.3 Cross Sections

Chapter 2

Klein-Gordon Equation